The Dhāraṇī of the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Essence of Awakening

Bodhigarbhālaṅkāralakṣadhāraṇī · Toh 920 · Derge Kangyur
བྱང་ཆུབ་ཀྱི་སྙིང་པོའི་རྒྱན་འབུམ་གྱི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Essence of Awakening, known in Sanskrit as the Bodhigarbhālaṅkāralakṣadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Byang chub kyi snying po'i rgyan 'bum gyi gzungs, is a short incantatory text consisting almost entirely of a single dhāraṇī, a sacred formula meant to be recited. After an opening homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, the formula pays reverence to a tathāgata whose name evokes a radiant golden banner at the crown, and to the Buddha Śākyamuni, before invoking the power of awakening and the mind of great awakening. It calls on the blessing and empowerment of all the tathāgatas to pacify and purify every kind of wrongdoing and to establish the reciter firmly on the path to great awakening. Formulas of this kind are traditionally associated with devotional practices such as the consecration of stūpas and sacred images. The work is Toh 920 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: bodhigarbhālaṅkāralakṣadhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Essence of Awakening.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas!

oṃ namo bhagavate vipula vadana kāñcanodkṣipta prabhāsa ketu murdhane tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhaya namo bhagavate śākyamunaye tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya tadyathā bodhi bodhi bodhani bodhani sarva tathāgata gocare dhara dhara hara hara prahara prahara mahābodhicitta dhāre culu culu śatarasmi sañcodite sarva tathāgatābhiṣikte guṇe guṇavate sarva buddhaṇāvabhase mili mili gaganatale sarva tathāgata adhiṣthite nabhastale śame śame praśame praśame sarva pāpaṃ praśamane sarva pāpaṃ viśvadhane hulu hulu mahābodhi mārga saṃpratiṣṭhite sarva tathāgatā supratiṣṭhite śuddhe svāhā

mūlamantraṃ

oṃ sarva tathāgata vyavalokite jaya jaya svāhā

hṛdayaṃ

oṃ huru huru jayamukhe svāhā

upahṛdayaṃ

oṃ vajra āyuṣe svāhā

If any monk, nun, layman or laywoman, or any other son or daughter of good family, writes out this dhāraṇī, builds a stupa, and places this dhāraṇī inside that stupa, then by building a single stupa that person will have built a hundred thousand. They will also have made offerings with divine flowers, incense, garlands, ointments, powders, garments, parasols, victory banners, pennants and the like. And it is not only the stupa that is honored: with those same offerings, the Precious Buddha, the Precious Dharma and the Precious Saṅgha will be honored as well.

Nanda, I have taught this sūtra, this dhāraṇī, for the sake of such beings as these: those of weak merit, those without faith, those of wrong view, those who doubt, those who commit the deeds of immediate retribution, those whose lives are short, the beings of the hells, animals, those in the world of Yama, and beings bound for the hell of uninterrupted torment.

Nanda, in the future, in the later age, those householders, and most monks as well, who do not read this dhāraṇī and do not make offerings to it, will suffer: just as householders are said to suffer, so too will those who have gone forth.

If, on the other hand, one who in this way honors the Buddha and listens to this builds a single stupa, the eighty-four thousand adorned with the Dharma will also be honored. Moreover, that person will have an immeasurable heap of merit. It will be as though they had read and recited the sūtra Adorned with Trees. They will also have entered the worldly and the transcendent maṇḍalas.

The Dhāraṇī of the Hundred Thousand, extracted from the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Essence of Awakening, is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The work called "Adorned with Trees" may be the Gaṇḍavyūha, but the title as written differs from that sūtra's usual Tibetan title, so it has been rendered literally. "The eighty-four thousand adorned with the Dharma" most likely refers to the eighty-four thousand stupas, or the eighty-four thousand sections of the Dharma, but the Tibetan does not specify.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a

human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.